

UPSC Philosophy Optional Paper 1 Simulation

QUESTION PAPER | Time: 3 Hours | Maximum Marks: 250

INSTRUCTIONS

1. The paper has two sections, A and B, and eight questions.
2. Question 1 and Question 5 are compulsory.
3. Answer three other questions, choosing at least one from each section.
4. Answer five questions in all. The marks carried by each subpart are indicated.

SECTION A - Western Philosophy

Q1 (COMPULSORY)

- (a) "Spinoza's God does no explanatory work outside the system." Examine this claim by comparing the role of God in Descartes and Spinoza. [10 marks]
- (b) "The golden mountain is very high." Discuss this statement in the context of Russell's theory of descriptions. [10 marks]
- (c) Explain Heidegger's notion of das Man and show why 'falling' is not a moral failing. [10 marks]
- (d) "The relation between cause and effect is one of constant conjunction". Examine Hume's criticism of causation in the light of the above statement. [10 marks]
- (e) "The verification principle is a criterion of meaning and not of truth." Examine this claim. (Answer in about 150 words.) [10 marks]

Q2

- (a) "The history of rationalist substance is a movement from dualism through monism to pluralism." Analyse the logic and the cost of this movement. [20 marks]
- (b) "All determination is negation." Comment with reference to Spinoza. [15 marks]
- (c) "Blue is one object of sensation and green is another, and consciousness, which both sensations have in common, is different from either." Present an account of Moore's refutation of idealism with reference to this statement. [15 marks]

Q3

- (a) "The Tractatus is a book that succeeds by failing." Critically examine this claim with reference to the doctrine of saying and showing. [20 marks]
- (b) "Consciousness is what it is not and is not what it is." In the light of this statement bring out the chief features of Sartre's conception of consciousness. [15 marks]
- (c) Examine Hume's refutation of Causal relation and Kant's response to it. [15 marks]

Q4

- (a) "Anxiety is not a stronger kind of fear." Examine the role of anxiety in Kierkegaard, Heidegger and Sartre, and assess whether a mood can disclose a philosophical truth. [20 marks]
- (b) Examine the protocol-sentence debate and assess its significance for the verification theory of meaning. (Answer in about 250 words.) [15 marks]
- (c) "We can affirm the truth of any sentence in our total system, in the face of whatever experience, just so long as we are prepared to make adjustments elsewhere." Discuss this statement in the light of Quine's 'Two Dogmas of Empiricism'. [15 marks]

SECTION B - Indian Philosophy

Q5 (COMPULSORY)

- (a) "All human knowledge is empirical and therefore relative." Critically examine Jaina theory of sevenfold judgement (saptabhanganaya) in the light of above statement. [10 marks]
- (b) Discuss the nature and different stages of Samadhi as per Patanjala yoga and examine the role of Isvara in it. [10 marks]
- (c) Do you think Carvaka's philosophy is positivistic in nature? Give reasons and justifications for your answer. [10 marks]
- (d) Critically discuss the metaphysical status of a Jiva and a Purusa according to Samkhya philosophy. [10 marks]
- (e) Explain the ground on which Carvaka rejects inference as a valid source of knowledge. [10 marks]

Q6

- (a) "Jainism preserves the reality of the world at the cost of the simplicity of logic; Advaita preserves the simplicity of logic at the cost of the reality of the world." Critically examine this comparison. [20 marks]
- (b) Compare and contrast the views of Sankara and Ramanuja regarding the status of the world. [15 marks]
- (c) "So long as there are changes and modifications in citta, the self is reflected therein, and, in the absence of discriminative knowledge, identifies itself with them." Present an appraisal of Yoga Soteriology in the light of the above statement. [15 marks]

Q7

- (a) Explain with reference to Yoga Philosophy, the nature of klesas. How does the removal of these lead to kaivalya? [20 marks]
- (b) Explain the differences of conception of Reality between Carvaka and Jainism. [15 marks]
- (c) How do the Advaita Vedantins react to the Prakrtiparinamavada of the Samkhya philosophy? How do the Samkhyas defend their own position in this regard? Discuss. [15 marks]

Q8

- (a) Analyse the Jaina fourteen stages of spiritual development. How do the two ladders explain spiritual relapse, and what does this show about the relation between insight and conduct in Jainism? [20 marks]
- (b) 'Both Ascetic and materialist are partial in their negation of each other'. Explain Sri Aurobindo's integral philosophy in the light of the above statement. [15 marks]
- (c) Explain the concepts of 'Anyathasiddha' and 'Ananyathasiddha' in the context of Asatkaryavada. [15 marks]

END OF PAPER